

Green & Social Claims Scan - Methodology

Detailed methodology for the Green & Social Claims Risk Assessment tool

1. Purpose and scope

The tool provides an indicative first-pass assessment of public green and social claims. It is designed to support claim governance, compliance review and better external communication. It is not a legal opinion, not a regulatory finding and not a definitive greenwashing or social-washing judgement.

The scan focuses on claim wording, substantiation, public-source contradiction signals and sector exposure. It does not produce a broad ESG rating.

2. Source and audience classification

The tool separates scanned sources into different communication channels because the same wording can carry different risk depending on its audience and use.

Source / channel	How it is treated
Client-facing / consumer-facing websites and documents	Homepages, product pages, folders, brochures, campaign pages and marketing pages are assessed as external claim communication. Green claims in this channel receive the strongest EmpCo relevance.
Investor / stakeholder reports	Annual reports, sustainability reports, ESG reports and integrated reports are used mainly as evidence, governance and consistency sources.
Policy / internal governance documents	Policies, supplier codes and procedures are used mainly as evidence for governance, due diligence, controls, grievance/remedy and traceability.
Mixed or unclear sources	The tool applies a cautious interpretation and flags where manual classification is required.

3. Regulatory and standards lenses

- EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825: used for environmental claims in consumer-facing commercial communication, including generic environmental claims, labels, comparisons, future environmental-performance claims and climate/offset wording.
- EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015: used for social and product-market claims involving forced labour, modern slavery, supplier traceability, responsible sourcing, imports/exports, product traceability and supply-chain assurance.
- OECD Guidelines, UN Guiding Principles, UN Global Compact and CSRD/ESRS: used as broader responsible-business reference frameworks for substantiation, due diligence, stakeholder scope, metrics, grievance/remedy and consistency checks.

Direct EmpCo and Forced Labour Regulation risk signals receive higher interpretive weight than broader responsible-business claims that are mainly linked to OECD, UNGC or UNGP expectations.

4. Claim taxonomy

Green claim categories include generic environmental claims, climate-neutrality or offsetting claims, circularity/recyclability/durability claims, comparative environmental claims, sustainability labels/certifications, future environmental-performance claims and absolute environmental wording.

Social claim categories include broad social-impact claims, responsible-business claims, human-rights and labour-rights claims, forced-labour or modern-slavery claims, supply-chain/responsible-sourcing claims, diversity/inclusion claims, worker-welfare claims and customer fairness/accessibility claims.

5. Scoring model

The tool calculates a green risk score, a social risk score and an integrated global score. Green and social scores use the same high-level structure:

Score component	Weight	Meaning
Claim wording risk	30%	Breadth, generic wording, absolute language, sensitivity, prominence and direct relevance to EmpCo or Forced Labour Regulation topics.
Substantiation / evidence-gap risk	30%	Missing scope, methodology, data, KPI, verification, limitations, traceability, grievance/remedy, corrective action or implementation evidence.
External contradictory-context risk	25%	External public-source signals that may contradict, qualify or contextualise the claim area. Company-owned documents are excluded from the external-source signal list.
Sector exposure	15%	Baseline sensitivity reflecting whether the sector is structurally more exposed to green/social claims risk. Sector exposure cannot create High risk on its own.

The global score integrates the green and social scores and applies a cautious adjustment where client-facing material is dominant. High-risk interpretation should normally require a sensitive or broad claim, a substantiation gap and/or relevant external contradiction.

6. Sector exposure

Some sectors are more prone to greenwashing or social-washing allegations because of high consumer visibility, high environmental impact, complex supply chains, labour-intensive operations, vulnerable customers or salient human-rights risks. Examples include apparel, food retail, energy, transport, finance, digital services and complex manufacturing. Sector exposure is used as a baseline sensitivity factor only.

7. External public-source layer

Where external search credentials are configured, the tool searches for claim-specific public-source signals. It aims to retain sources such as regulators, courts, NGOs, civil-society organisations, credible media or public investigations. Company-owned websites, policies and reports are excluded from the external-source signal section, although they may still be used as reviewed documents or evidence sources.

8. Recommended actions

Actions are generated from the detected claim types and source/channel classification. The tool prioritises EmpCo controls for client-facing green claims, Forced Labour Regulation evidence for product/supplier/forced-labour claims, and claim-specific evidence files for priority claims.

9. Limitations and disclaimer

The tool relies on accessible HTML pages and public search results. It may miss PDF-only content, paywalled sources, blocked websites, images, videos or internal evidence. Automated crawling and keyword-based detection require manual validation. This is not legal advice, not a legal compliance assessment and not a definitive greenwashing or social-washing finding.